

Guideline on Leave Application and Approval (GL/HR/2024/02)

Reference No.: GL/HR/2024/02

Effective Date: 1 January 2024

Owner: Human Resources Department, Jabatan Pembangunan Digital Sarawak

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This guideline explains how staff apply for leave, how leave is approved, and what entitlements apply at the Department.

1.2 Scope

It applies to all permanent and confirmed contract staff. Probationary staff follow the same process but have restrictions listed in section 5.

2. Types of Leave

2.1 Annual Leave

- a. Staff with less than 10 years of service are entitled to 20 days of annual leave per year.
- b. Staff with 10 or more years of service are entitled to 25 days of annual leave per year.
- c. Up to 10 days of unused annual leave may be carried forward to the following year and must be used before 31 March.

2.2 Sick Leave

- a. Staff are entitled to 14 days of sick leave per year without hospitalisation, and 60 days with hospitalisation.
- b. A medical certificate from a registered practitioner is required for any sick leave of two (2) consecutive days or more.
- c. The staff member must inform the Head of Unit before 9.00 am on the first day of absence.

2.3 Maternity and Paternity Leave

- a. Maternity leave is 90 consecutive days for each confinement, for up to five (5) children.
- b. Paternity leave is seven (7) consecutive days, to be taken within 30 days of the birth.

2.4 Emergency Leave

Emergency leave of up to three (3) days per year may be granted for bereavement or serious family emergencies, charged to annual leave.

2.5 Hajj and Umrah Leave

Hajj leave of up to 40 days is allowed once in a career, with the application submitted at least 90 days in advance.

3. Application Procedure

3.1 Submission

- a. Applications are submitted through the HRMS using Form SM-02 (Leave Application).
- b. Annual leave of up to three (3) days must be applied for at least three (3) working days in advance.
- c. Annual leave longer than five (5) consecutive days must be applied for at least 14 days in

advance.

3.2 Approval Authority

- a. Leave of up to five (5) days is approved by the Head of Unit.
- b. Leave of six (6) to 14 days is approved by the Head of Division.
- c. Leave of 15 days or more is approved by the Director of Human Resources.

3.3 Turnaround

The approving officer must decide within two (2) working days. If no decision is made within that time, the application is escalated to the next level.

4. Handover

Staff going on leave of more than three (3) days must name a relief officer in the HRMS and complete a handover note for urgent tasks.

5. Special Conditions

5.1 Probationary Staff

Probationary staff may take annual leave only after three (3) months of service, up to a maximum of five (5) days during the first year.

5.2 Peak Periods

Annual leave is not normally approved during the year-end closing period from 15 December to 31 December for staff in the Finance and Procurement Departments.

6. Records

The Human Resources Department keeps the leave balance. Staff may view their balance in the HRMS at any time, and a statement is issued every 31 January.